Land is probably the single most valuable asset in the country today. Not only could greater liquidity for land allow more resources to be redeployed efficiently in agriculture, it could ease the way for land-utilising businesses to set up. Perhaps as important, it could allow land to serve as collateral for credit. Three important steps are needed regarding it[14]:

i. to map land carefully and assign conclusive title,
ii. to facilitate land leasing, and
iii. to create a fair but speedy process of land acquisition for public purposes.

The National Land Records Modernisation Programme (NLRMP), started in 2008, aims at updating and digitising land records by the end of the Twelfth Plan. Eventually, the intent is to move from *presumptive title* (where registration of a title does not imply the owner's title is legally valid) to *conclusive title* (where it does). Important points related to this process may be summarised as follows:

a. Digitisation will help enormously in lowering the costs of land transactions, while conclusive title will eliminate legal uncertainty and the need to use the government as an intermediary for acquiring land so as to 'cleanse' title.
b. Given the importance of this programme, its rollout in various states needs to be accelerated. Easier and quicker land transactions will especially help small and medium enterprises that do not have the legal support or the management capacity that large enterprises have.
c. Prohibitory *land leasing norms* raises the cost to rural-urban migration as villagers are unable to lease their land, and often have to leave the land untilled or leave a family member behind to work the land. Lifting these restrictions can help the landless (or more efficient landowners) get land from those who migrate, even while it will allow landowners with education and skills to move to industry or services.
d. Compulsory registration of leaseholds and of the owner's title would provide tenants and landowners protection.